Source Documents

- GreenThreads Case Brief
- GT_HR_Denver_ Applicants Dataset
- City and County of Denver Department of finance/Denver labor: Denver local minimum wage adjusted to $19.29 per hour for 2026, published August 7, 2025(External sanity-check source)
- Source 4: Offer Letter -GT-HR Sales Associate

Revised and clean datasheet

- https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/16Chg_W2Klxqx_HIiDdwoO1E0DQFj-Xwk8fIJXlIXtKQ/edit?usp=sharing

1. Anchor To My Function

For this project, I am continuing the HR opportunity from my functional brief: using AI to help the existing GreenThreads HR team organize the Denver hiring pipeline, flag follow-up needs, and prepare clear iron that GreenThreads has 90 days to open the Denver store without adding new corporate headcount. The store needs 14 employees; seven positions are already accepted, and seven remain open. The applicant dataset contains 148 records. The goal is to reduce repetitive documentation and tracking while keeping HR and the store manager responsible for the final employment decision. (GreenThreads case brief, pp. 1-2, 5).

2. Documents Analyst

Source 1: GreenThreads Case Brief
Classification: Official company case brief and operating context document.

Extraction: The brief sets a 90-day Denver opening deadline, a $450,000 launch budget, and zero new corporate hires. Denver needs 14 store employees: one store manager, two assistant managers, eight sales associates, two stock associates, and one visual merchandiser. Seven positions are already accepted, and seven remain open. The brief identifies sales associates as the hardest role to fill quickly. It also states that GreenThreads has no formal AI policy, even though it holds employee and customer data. The budget includes $65,000 for staffing and recruiting and $20,000 for technology in the system (Case brief pp. 1–2, 4).

Summary: The case brief shows a capacity problem for HR. The existing team must finish hiring and onboarding under a fixed deadline without adding corporate staff. AI could improve document intelligence and be the first AI used for automated hiring.AI can organize records, surface delays, and prepare the status of some reasons why human HR staff remain responsible for employment decisions.

Prompt Iteration: A broad prompt such as " summarize the case " returned product marketing and operations details that were not needed for the HR decision. I narrow the prompt to use all the case briefs to extract the key facts affecting Denver HR hiring. Deadline required: headcount filled/open seats, recruiting budget, technology budget, and AI government limits. Do not add the submission; the narrator prompt product is a more relevant and verifiable output.

Verification
I checked the 90- day deadline and budget against page one of the 14-person staffing plan and seven open/some accepted status against pages 1 -2, and the budget and no AI policy statement against page 4.

Source 2 to GT – HR – Denver – Applicants Dataset

Classification: HR Recruiting and applicant tracking dataset

Method: I analyzed all 148 rows following the instructor's HR guidance. I filled the pipeline stage-by-stage, compared offered rates to the Denver market rate column, examined how long applicants sit between Contacts, and cross-checked the record deadline reason. And compare offered rates with the Denver market rate. I did not rank applicants or interfere with qualifications that are not in the file. I compared offered rates to the Denver market-rate column, examined how long applicants had gone between contacts, and cross-checked decline reasons against offered rates versus the Denver market rate. I did not rank applicants or infer qualifications that are not present in the file.

Extractions: The dataset contains 64 applied, 42 screened, 24 interviewed, 7 offers accepted, and 11 offers declined, totaling 148 records. There are 18 extended offers in total: 7 accepted and 11 declined, for a 38.9% overall offer-acceptance rate. Thirty-six applicants have gone at least 30 days since last contact - 17 in Applied, 17 in Screened, and 2 in Interview - with a maximum observed contact gap of 43 days. Sales associate is the largest role group with88 applicants. Eleven sales associate offers were extended, but only 2 were accepted, for an 18.2% acceptance rate for that role. Of the 9 declined sales associate offers, 5 cited pay below expectation, 3 cited accepting another offer, and 1 cited a start date too far out. The sales associate offer rate is $17.50/hour against a $19.75/hour Denver market rate, a $2.25/hour gap. The maximum observed stage-transition times are 4 days from Applied to Screen, 9 days from Screen to Interview, 7 days from Interview to Offer, and 9 days from Offer to Decision.

Summary: The applicant file shows two main operational problems. First, the pipeline is aging: many applicants remain in Applied or Screened and have gone more than a month without contact. Second, offer conversion is weak, especially for the sales associate role. Compensation and timing concerns appear repeatedly in the decline data. This makes pipeline follow-up and offer strategy more urgent than automated candidate ranking.

Prompt Iteration: An early prompt asking for the "best applicants" was not appropriate, because the file does not contain enough job-qualification information to support a fair ranking. I revised the prompt to use only the available columns: count applicants by stage and role, calculate offer outcomes, summarize decline reasons, identify stale records using days since last contact, and compare offer rate with Denver market rate. I instructed the model not to rank applicants or infer experience, availability, or suitability.

Verification: For the second pass, I recalculated all figures directly from the 148 records instead of relying on the first AI summary. The stage counts reconciled to 148, and 7 accepted plus 11 declined reconciled to the 18 extended offers. I also rechecked the 36 records with 30+ days since last contact, the decline-reason counts, and the stage-time

Source 3: City and County of Denver, 2026 Minimum Wage Announcement

Classification: Official government announcement.

Extraction: The City and County of Denver announced that the local minimum wage will increase to $19.29 per hour beginning January 1, 2026. A reduced tipped rate applies only to qualifying food and beverage workers; the announcement states that the tip credit does not apply to workers in other industries (City and County of Denver, August 7, 2025).

Summary: This external source revealed an important data-quality and HR-compliance risk. The applicant dataset lists $17.50 per hour for sales associates and $18.00 per hour for stock associates, both below the official $19.29 Denver 2026 minimum-wage benchmark. Because the store is located in Denver and the dataset uses a 2026 proposed start date, HR should verify the approved hourly rate schedule before extending more offers. This is a sanity-check finding, not a substitute for legal review.

Prompt Iteration: A vague question such as "is GreenThreads' pay enough?" could invite unsupported legal or market assumptions. I narrowed the research prompt to use only an official City and County of Denver source to verify the 2026 local minimum wage and compare that figure only against the hourly offer rates in the dataset, flagging any numeric inconsistency without drawing a legal conclusion.

The third theme is compensation risk. GreenThreads lists sales associates at $17.50 per hour against a $19.75 Denver market rate, and stock associates at $18.00 per hour against an $18.50 market rate. The external Denver source is a more serious sanity check: the city's announced 2026 local minimum wage of $19.29 per hour, effective January 1, 2026, is higher than both offer rates. I am not treating this as a final legal determination, but it is a clear data-quality and compliance flag that should be reviewed before more hourly offers are issued. This comparison also shows why a plausible-looking internal spreadsheet can pass unnoticed until it is checked against an authoritative outside source.

Role Offered Rate Denver Market Rate 2026 Denver Minimum($19.29)

Role	**Offered Rate**	**Denver Market Rate**	**2026 Denver minimum ($19.29)**
Sales Associate	**$17.50/hr**	**$19.75/hr**	**Below Minimum**
Stock Associate	**$18.00/hr**	**$18.00/hr**	**Below Minimum**

The sources also revealed an important information gap. My HR opportunity focuses on using AI to help with hiring and onboarding, but the applicant dataset does not contain the qualification fields needed for a fair candidate-level recommendation - there is no verified retail experience, customer service history, availability, leadership experience, resume content, or interview score. Asking AI to rank applicants from this file would force the model to infer or invent information. The correct use of AI is therefore to group by stage, flag stale records, organize decline reasons, compare pay fields, and draft status updates for human review - not automated selection. A final cross-source issue is governance. GreenThreads has no formal AI policy, even though it holds real employee and customer data, which makes applicant data especially sensitive. GreenThreads should not enter identifiable applicant information into an unapproved public AI tool. A safer design uses an approved environment with data minimization or de-identification, limited access, a record of source use, and human review before any decision affects an applicant. This also matches the business constraints in the case brief: the staffing/recruiting budget is $65,000, and the technology budget is $20,000, so the pilot should be small, practical, and measured by workflow improvement rather than a large new platform purchase.

Overall, the evidence supports a human-reviewed AI workflow that gives HR faster visibility into the pipeline: a daily stale-candidate list, a weekly stage summary, an offer-decline dashboard, and simple pay-field checks. Success should be measured by fewer 30-day contact gaps, faster movement out of Applied and Screened, stronger offer acceptance (especially for sales associates), and progress toward filling the seven remaining seats before Denver.

Verification: I used the official city and county of Denver announcement dated August 7, 2025, that states that the 2026 local minimum wage is $19.29 per hour beginning January 1, 2026. I didn't compare that figure with the sales associate and stock associate offer rate value in the dataset.

Source 4: Offer Letter -GT-HR Sales Associate

Classification: Internal HR document- an actual generated offer letter for a sales associate candidate in the Denver pipeline used as a concrete document-level example of pay and start date pattern identified in Sources 2 and 3.

The letter is extracted below exactly as issued
HR-sales associate offer letter
GreenThreads Denver store
Offer of employment date: June 12th 2026
Candidate
Position: Sales Associate, GreenThreads Denver

Dear Candidate, we are excited to offer you the position of sales associate at our new Denver store. Details of your offer are below.

- **Rate** of pay: $17.50 per hour
- **Status:** part-time non-exempt up to 28 hours per week
- **Proposed start date:** September 28th 2026
- **Reports to:** Store manager, Denver

Your start date is set to align with our store opening timeline and pre-opening training schedule because the Denver store is still in build-out onboarding for sales floor style for not begin until late September we appreciate your flexibility in old and availability until then this position includes green tread standard part-time benefits employee merchandise discount suitable uniform allowance and access to our wellness program this offer is Contagion on successful completion of background check and remain open for five business days from the date above we hope you will join us in bringing green chairs to Denver.

warm regards

GreenTheads

Extract: Offered rates $17.50 per hour, start date September 28th, 2016, hours of the 28 hours a week offer expired fabulous days.

Summary: This letter is a document-level analysis in terms of two patterns already found in the aggregate dataset. First, the $17.50 hourly rate is $1.79 below the official Denver 2026 minimum wage of $19.29, confirmed in source three. This is not a hypothetical compliance risk but a specific offer that appears to be noncompliant and should be reviewed before it is finalized or reissued. Second. The proposal start date, September 28, 2026, falls roughly 3 1/2 months after the date the offer itself expires, and only five business days that mismatch a short acceptance window pair with a distant start date. Is a plausible mechanism behind the start date to far-out decline reason that accounts for three of the 11 declined offers in source to the letter on closing prompt. Asking a model to classify what would make a candidate accept or decline is itself an example of the candidate judgment task this projectBradley avoids automating.

Prom iterationThe letter template includes a built-in instruction asking the model to classify can accept decline behavior I did not run the classification since predicting an individual candidate decision from a formal letter would requireAffair and motivation and personal circumstances not present in any source document instead I limit use of the document to extracting its state tax rate our start date expiration windowAnd connecting them to a pattern already verified in source two and three.

Verification of $17. 50 per-hour rate and September 28, 2026 start date for a check directly against the letter text, and match the offer rate and proposal start value associated with the sales associate record in the applicant data set. The five-business-day expiration window is stated directly in the letter.

Grounding And Verification
I traced the most important violence back to the source passage or data set fields; the table below records the grounding and use for the final synthesis.

Key claim	Source	Exact support
90-day opening deadline: zero new corporate hires	GreenThreads case brief	P.1
14 Denver store seats: seven accepted and seven open sales associate hardest set to fill	GreenThreads case brief	PP.1–2
$65,000 staffing/recruiting $20,000 tech/system no formal AI policy	GT – HR – Denver applicants	P.4
148 applicant records and stage counts	GT – HR – Denver Africans	Applicant ID and current stage field
Court six applicants with 30+ days since last contact, maximum for 43 days	GT – HR – Denver applicants	Days since last contact
18 offers, seven accepted, and 11 declined	GT – HR – Denver applicants	Offer extended, offer accepted, current stage
Five pay declines, three other offer declines, three start date declines	GT – HR – Denver applicants	Decline reason
Sales associate $17 and 50 Cent offer versus $19.75 data set market rate	GT – HR – Denver applicants	Offered a rate and Denver market rate field
Denver 2026 local Minimum wage equal	City and County of Denver	Official announcement published August 7, 2025

Second pass check: I calculated the applicant from the folder set and re-checked the key source passages after the initial area analysis. Any claim that could not be traced to Source was removed or treated as a gap rather than filled in the model.

Multiple source synthesis Brief

Decision Question: How should GreenThreads use AI to help HR finish Denver Hiring On time without incorporating headcount or giving AI control over employment decisions?
The three sources point to one clear conclusion: GreenThreads does not need AI to decide who gets hired. It needs AI to help the existing HR team control a crowded stage in the hiring pipeline and catch operational problems before the 90-day opening deadline. The case brief creates the business pressure the Denver store needs: 14 employees, seven seats are still open, no new corporate HR Staff can be added, and sales associates are readily identified as the hardest role to fill. The applicant dataset shows what that pressure looks like in practice. While Denver source provides an external check on one of the biggest Compensation issues in the dataset.

The first theme is pipeline congestion and follow-up risk: of 148 applicants, 64 are still applied and 42 screened, so more than seven out of 10 records remain in the first stage. 36 applicants have gone at least 30 days since last contact, including 17 applied and 17 screened. The longest observed contact gap is 43 days; the former stage transition maximum is much shorter, at four days. The screened stage is nine days from screen to interview, seven days from interview to offer, and nine days from offer to decision. So the bigger problem is not only the time required to complete a step; it is the record that stops moving and is not contacted for a long period. An AI-assisted status report could make these stale records visible every day and reduce the chance that candidates quietly disappear from the process.

The second theme is that the sales associate role is the center staffing Button.
The case brief says sales associates represent eight of the 14 seats, and it is the hardest role to fill fast. The dataset reinforced that statement rather than contradicting it. 88 of the 148 applicants are Sales associate applicants and sales associate offer were extended but only two were accepted that is an 18.2% offer acceptance rate for the role nine sales associate offer were declined five stated pay below expectation three stated start date that was too far out and one candidate accept another offer this means HR should not respond to the sales associate problem by simply sending more applicant through the same process. The offer strategy and candidate follow-up need attention first.

The third theme is compensation risk: the GreenThreads list sales associates at $17.50 per hour against the $19.75 Denver market rate and stock associates at $18 per hour against the $18.50 market rate. The external Denver source is a more serious sanity check. The city Announced 2026 local minimum wage of $19.29 per hour begin January 1, 2026 the sales associate and stock associate offer feel are both lower than officially benchmark I am not treating this as a final legal determination but it is clear that quality and HR compliance flag that should be reviewed before more hourly offers are issued the source comparison also show why the assignments revocation Requirement spreadsheet can look plausible until it is checked against an authoritative Outside source. The sources also revealed an important information gap my HR opportunity in one focus on using AI to help with hiring an onboard but the applicant dataset does not contain the qualification feel needed for a fair cabinet level recommendation there is no verified retail experience customer service history availability leadership experience résumé content or interview score in the column analyze asking area to rank applicant from this file would force the model to interfere or invent information. The correct AI use is therefore control grouping by stage, flagging stale records, organizing declined reasons, comparing and pay field, and drafting status updates for human view, not automated selection.

A final cross-source issue is governance.GreenThreads has no formal AI policy even though it holds real employees and consumer data that makes HR applicant data especially sensitive GreenThreads should not copy identify applicant information into an unapproved public AI tools the safer design is an approved environment with data minimization or D- identification limited access a record of the source use and human review before any decisions affect an applicant this also matches the business constrict in the case brief the pilot should be small and practical because staffing/recruiting at $65,000 budget line and technological system has $20,000 The goal should be measurable with flow improvement not a large no platform purchase.
Overall the evidence support a human review AI workflow that gives HR faster visibility into the pipeline a daily stale candidate list weekly stage summary offer declined dashboard and simple pay field checks with directly addressed the problem shown in the dataset and should be measured by fewer 30 days contact gaps faster movement out of applied and screen stronger offer acceptance especially for sale associate and progress towards filling the seven remaining seats before the Denver opening.

Actionable inside for HR

1. Verify the hourly wage schedule before issuing more offers. Sales associate $17.50 and stock associate $18 are below the official Denver 2026 minimum wage benchmark of $19.29 and should be reviewed immediately.
2. Making sales associate the first hiring priority, it represents eight of 14 store seats, 88 of the 148 applicant records, and only two of 11 sales associate offers accepted.
3. Create a daily sales candidate report for flat applicants with 30+ days since last contact with special attention to applying and screening the current dataset containing 36 Records.
4. Use AI for pipeline control, not candidate judgment. AI can summarize stage flag follow-ups, or decline reason draft, HR review outreach, and prepare manager status report; it should not reject rank or select candidates from this dataset.

5. Address start date friction: three declined offers state a start date that was too far out. HR should review whether earlier or Stage onboarding is possible for rules that are ready to start.
6. Add validated qualification data before using AI for candidate-level screening résumé experience, availability, and interview information must be available and constantly defined before AI is asked to summarize suitability.
7. Keep the pilot small and measurable trucks still contact count, stage movement, and offer acceptance. HR time saved and number of remaining seats filled before expanding the Workflow.

Conclusion

The document analyst supports a focus on AI opportunity for a green train HR; the strongest use is not automatic hiring; it is helping the existing team manage a large African pipeline under a fixed deadline. The verified data show earliest stage congestion, long contact gaps week sales associate offer converse conversionRepeated pay, and short start date. Concern: an hourly offer field that needs immediate review against their 2026 wage. While preserving HR accountability, GreenThreads should begin Weight pipeline reporting and follow-up support, measure the result, and only expand the use of AI after the data governance rules and qualification input are strong enough to support it.

Prompt – tools and verification

Key prompts

Basic dataset prompts: Analyze the GreenThreads Denver applicant dataset and identify the main hiring pipeline issues.

Improve costar prompt: Context: GreenThreads is hiring for its Denver store and needs to understand where candidates are getting stuck in the hiring pipeline. Objective: Analyze the Applicant data to identify pipeline bottlenecks, follow-up delays, pay concerns, decline reasons, and stage timing.

Style: Use clear, professional business language and base all findings only on the provided dataset.
Tone: Objective and analytical; audience: GreenThreads HR leadership and hiring managers.
Response: Summarize the key findings, support them with numbers from the data asset, and provide practical recommendations. Do not rank applicants or invent Qualifications that are not in the file.

Case brief prompt: Use only the case brief; extract the facts that affect the Denver HR hiring deadline, required headcount fill/opening seats, recruiting budget, technological budget, and AI governance limit; do not add assumptions.

External sanity check prompt: Using an official city and county Denver source, verify the 2026 local minimum wage and compare that number only with the hourly offer field in the green thread applicant data said flag numeric inconsistencies; do not make a final legal conclusion.

What changed when I iterated

The first prompt was too broad and encouraged general summaries. The improved prompt named the exact business question, field audience, and evidence requirements. The most important change was telling the model to use only the supply source. See when information was missing and avoid candidate ranking that made the report easier to verify and reduced plausible but unsupported statements.

Tool/model Tier

I use ChatGPT with the GPT 5.16 K model to organize the documents, refine the prompt, and synthesize the findings. I use Google Sheets to filter the review of the applicant data, and I use a direct calculation pass across all 148 rows for the numeric verification for the week for external reserve and to check. I use an official city and county of Denver government source rather than a blog or salary website.

Verification method

- **Case facts were traced to the exact page of the official GreenThreads case Brief.**
- **Applicant stage counts were recapitulated across all 148 rows and reconciled to the set total.**
- **Offer I'll come reconcile: seven accepted, 11 declined, equal 18 extended**
- **The 36 applicants with 30+ days since last contact were recounted by stage: 17 apply, 17 screen, and two interview**
- **Declined reasons were checked against the 11 decline offer rows**
- **A comparison used offered rate and Denver market rate directly from the data set**
- **The 2026 Denver minimum wage figure was checked against the official city and county of Denver announcement**
- **The second pass calculation was used to catch or remove any AI statement that did not match the source data**

Data government consideration

Applicant information: Is HR data GreenThread? Should use an approved AI environment, minimize our de-identified personal information where possible, restrict access to employees who need the data, and keep a record of the source information and reviewer identifiable. Applicant records should not automatically be entered into an unapproved public consumer AI tool. AI may organize and summarize job-related information but final employment decisions must remain with trained HR staff and managers.

References

GreenThreads- GreenThreads– Case brief
GreenThreads- GT – HR – Denver applicant tracking data said 148 records.
City and County of Denver Department of Finance: Denver local minimum wage is adjusted to $19.29 per hour for 2022 August 7, 2025, www.denvergov.org